particular equilibrium outcome. The logic of BRICS coordination games usually involves a different ordering of preferences. For example, despite pressing for a larger role for the ruble in its region after the plunge in oil prices in 2014, Russia benefited from earning valuable dollars from resource exports, such as oil sales priced in dollars when production costs and the Russian budget were in devalued rubles. In sum, common aversions provide necessary focal points for BRICS collaboration.

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However, aversions alone are not sufficient to explain the expansion and deepening of BRICS cooperation over the past decade or the range of goals of BRICS collective efforts. Existing research is divided over the next brick in the conceptual wall—whether the BRICS in the global governance system are best conceptualized as (a) *joiners*, who for the most part bury their distributional disputes and resentments over voice and positions to the service of the potentially greater gains that they reap from rising in the incumbent order; (b) *spoilers*, hard-core revisionists who want to overturn the incumbent institutions and replace them with new ones that better serve their (and particularly China's) interests; or (c) *shirkers*, who despite the diffusion of power are not full-blown dissatisfied challengers and thus prefer to free-ride, accepting the current hegemony until a new negotiated order fitfully evolves.[40]

The liberal institutionalist perspective provides one influential view on the dynamics of how the international system accommodates rising actors. It maintains that China and other increasingly important powers are *joiners* that gradually will be drawn to integrate into the existing liberal order from which they benefit. According to G. John Ikenberry, China and other rising powers will be sufficiently satisfied with and integrate into the well-institutionalized American order because it is "more open, more consensual and rule-based than past hegemonic orders," is "easier to join and harder to overturn," binds the hegemon, offers "tangible material benefits" that are widely shared through an open trading system, and creates opportunities for voice while accommodating rising powers by redistributing authority roles.[41] Similarly, David Lake suggests that states comply with subjective international orders because of the dual roles of authority and legitimacy in hierarchical relationships.[42]